

Question:

A 34-year-old woman presents to her OB/GYN with complaints of missing her last 3 periods as well as intermittent spontaneous milky-white nipple discharge bilaterally for the past 3 months. Vital signs are stable and within normal limits. Neurologic examination is without abnormality, including normal visual fields. Serology and MRI of the brain are ordered, with results pending. Which of the following sets of laboratory results would be expected in this patient?

Answer Choices:

- A. Decreased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH
- B. Decreased prolactin, increased FSH, increased LH
- C. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, increased LH
- D. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To answer this question , we need to consider the patient's symptoms and the possible causes .

The patient's symptoms of missed periods and spontaneous milky -white nipple discharge are consistent with hyperprolactinemia , which is often caused by an increase in the production of prolactin in the body .

The patient's age and symptoms make it likely that she is experiencing a condition such as hypothyroidism or a pituitary tumor , which can cause an increase in prolactin levels .

Therefore , it is likely that the patient's laboratory results will show an increase in prolactin levels , with normal or decreased levels of FSH and LH .

This is consistent with the most likely diagnosis of hyperprolactinemia , which is often caused by an increase in the production of prolactin in the body .

The other options are less likely to be correct , as decreased prolactin levels are not consistent with the patient's symptoms , and increased FSH and LH levels are not typically associated with hyperprolactinemia .

Based on the patient's symptoms and the possible causes , it is most likely that the laboratory results will show :

<answer> Increased prolactin , decreased FSH , decreased LH </answer>

